MATAN BARASH

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Systems-driven Game Designer specializing in gameplay mechanics, pacing balance, and interactive user flows. Proven track record of architecting engaging level layouts, prototyping responsive player controls, and leveraging telemetry and playtesting to eliminate friction. Collaborative partner across agile teams (Art, Engineering, QA) bridging high-level design vision with hands-on engine implementation.

EXPERIENCE

Level & Systems Designer

Six Minds Studio — Remote
2026–Present — Unreal Engine

- **Level Layout & Spatial Flow:** Authored 3D level layouts and spatial pacing in Unreal Engine, focusing on intuitive player guidance, sightlines, and structured encounter flow.
- **Mechanics & Interaction Design:** Prototyped and iterated on core gameplay mechanics and input responsiveness, aligning environmental interaction with player agency.
- **Data-Informed Tuning:** Analyzed playtest feedback and interaction telemetry to refine difficulty curves, eliminate player drop-off, and polish encounter pacing.
- **Cross-Functional Collaboration:** Partnered closely with engineering, art, and QA in an agile pipeline to ensure design intentions met strict visual and performance benchmarks.

Teaching Assistant – Introductory Unity & Systems

Tel Aviv University — Tel Aviv, Israel
Oct 2024–Apr 2026

- **Interaction & Onboarding Design:** Streamlined user onboarding flows by auditing action paths and reducing redundant interactions per session to lower early drop-off.
- **Prototyping & Pipeline Speed:** Reduced development iteration cycles by 30% by integrating rapid-prototyping workflows and Azure AI Foundry utility tools into team pipelines.
- **Sprint & Feature Mentorship:** Guided 10+ student teams through end-to-end feature lifecycles, translating abstract game concepts into actionable user stories and sprint backlogs.
- **Playtesting & UX Auditing:** Conducted regular build evaluations and usability playtests to diagnose UX friction, edge-case mechanics conflicts, and responsiveness bugs prior to milestone submissions.

EDUCATION & COURSES

Tel Aviv University — 2024–2026
M.A., Digital Media Lab – Interactive Design & Creative Technology — Tel Aviv, Israel

Tel Aviv University — 2022–2025
B.A., Digital Media Lab – Visual & Interactive Media — Tel Aviv, Israel

GameDev.tv Courses — 2024–2025
Unreal Engine Workflows, Unity 3D Developer (Unity 6 & C#), Unity Mobile Game Development, Unity VR/XR Developer — Online

MILITARY SERVICE

Combat Medic
Taoz Battalion
Nov 2017–Jul 2020 — Israel

SKILLS & TOOLS

Game & Systems Design: Core Gameplay Loops, Level Layout & Pacing, Mechanic Prototyping, Player Guidance, Economy & Progression Balance.

UX & Analytics: Playtest Facilitation, Telemetry Analysis, User Flow Optimization, Feature Roadmapping, Agile/Scrum.

Engines & Implementation: Unreal Engine, Unity (2D/3D, Mobile, PC VR), C# Scripting, Blueprints, Azure AI Foundry, Version Control (Git/GitHub).

Languages: English (Native), Hebrew (Native), Japanese (Basic).